

GuardSpine Lead Angel Targeting Research

Executive summary

The EU AI Act entered into force on **1 Aug 2024** and becomes **fully applicable on 2 Aug 2026** (with phased exceptions). ¹ This creates a definable catalyst window for investors who pay for *audit-grade evidence* and *traceability*, and who believe the fastest distribution is developer-native (e.g., GitHub workflows → defensible artifacts).

What was produced

A 40-candidate lead-angel longlist (scored 0–100 across **capacity**, **scar tissue**, **AI-governance thesis**, and **speed**) plus **top-10 intro hooks** and **recommended closing sequences** (Operator / DevTools / Reg-thesis). Every included data point is linked to a public source; unverifiable fields are marked **unspecified**.

Source spine

Primary collection emphasized public investor lists and official pages: Vanta/Snyk/Secureframe investor listings on Wellfound; Secureframe's newsroom (named angels); the `["organization","Silicon Valley CISO Investments","angel syndicate"]` public roster/operating notes; and publicly accessible LinkedIn activity referencing EU AI Act / AI governance. ²

Deliverables

[Download the full report](#)
[Download the candidate table CSV](#)

Known gaps

Public sources rarely disclose individual check sizes or document specific audit incidents; those fields remain **unspecified** unless directly evidenced, and should be resolved via warm-intro discovery and diligence calls.

¹ AI Act | Shaping Europe's digital future
<https://digital-strategy.ec.europa.eu/en/policies/regulatory-framework-ai>

² Vanta Funding Rounds, Valuation & Investors
<https://wellfound.com/company/vanta/funding>